

MAHL STICK

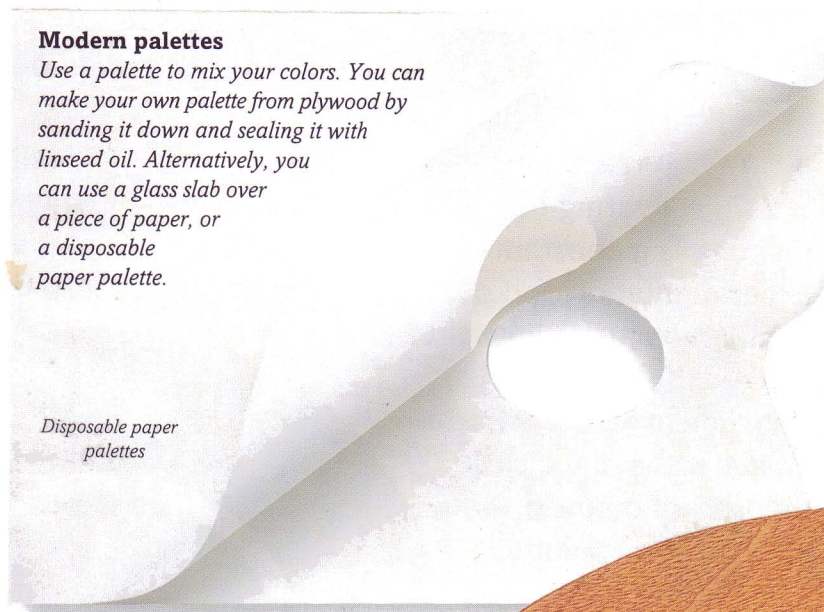
If you need a steady hand to work on a particular area, use a mahl stick. A mahl stick is a piece of light bamboo, about 1.25m (4ft) long, with a ball-shaped end covered in soft chamois leather. You can make your own mahl stick if you prefer.



Modern palettes

Use a palette to mix your colors. You can make your own palette from plywood by sanding it down and sealing it with linseed oil. Alternatively, you can use a glass slab over a piece of paper, or a disposable paper palette.

Disposable paper palettes



EASELS

There are a variety of easels available from artists' suppliers, from the simple sketching easel that folds right up for easy carrying on location, to the heavy studio easels that can hold large paintings comfortably. Some artists like to work on paintings suspended on nails on a studio wall, or propped up on a table, but it makes sense to have a good adjustable easel for your work.



Vertical studio easel



Sketching easel



Radial studio easel

Mahogany palette

This kidney-shaped mahogany palette, with its characteristic dark red-brown color, was originally developed for artists who worked on a similarly colored painting surface. This meant colors on the palette could be seen as they would look on the painting.



HEALTH HAZARD

Solvents can damage your health – screw the lid on after use and keep your studio well ventilated.



Solvent

You need to use a certain amount of solvent to dilute your colors and clean your equipment. Use either white spirit or turpentine.



Drying oil

Linseed oil is the basic medium for binding colored pigments and drying them when painted. Use it to modify the consistency of paint.



Oil painting medium

This enhances the consistency and glossiness of oil paint. If you don't want to buy it, mix refined linseed oil, or stand oil, with turpentine.



Varnish

Varnishes are designed to protect a painting and give it a matt or a gloss finish. Dammar varnish and ketone varnish are recommended.